

Demonstration of the `pullquote` LaTeX Package

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Introduction

This document showcases `pullquote.sty`, the standalone LaTeX distribution of the `pullquote` environment for documents compiled directly with (pdf/Xe/Lua)LaTeX, without Pandoc or Quarto. Each example below mirrors one in `test/pullquote-examples.md` (the Pandoc/Quarto specimen), translated from `pq-*` attributes to the `.sty`'s own `width`, `color`, `size`, `skip`, `align`, `boxalign`, `barwidth`, `barcolor`, and `padding*` keys, so both specimens exercise the same feature set and stay easy to compare side by side.

Engine Note: compile with `lualatex` or `xelatex` (what `make docs` uses) for font parity with the other three specimens — Noto Serif, Noto Sans, and Fira Mono, all loaded via `fontspec` below. `pdflatex` still compiles this document, but silently falls back to Computer Modern throughout, since `fontspec` isn't available on that engine.

Installation Note: place `pullquote.sty` on your `TEXINPUTS` or alongside your document, then load it with `\usepackage{pullquote}`.

Basic Example

Ordinary paragraph text before the `pullquote`, to show how it breaks the flow of the page.

"Typography is the craft of endowing human language with a durable visual form." — Robert Bringhurst

Ordinary paragraph text after the `pullquote`. The keys below match the `tcolorbox`-backed environment defined in `pullquote.sty`: `width`, `color`, `size`, `skip`, `align`, `boxalign`, `barwidth`, `barcolor`, and `paddingleft`/`paddingright`/`paddingtop`/`paddingbottom`.

Font Sizing

There's no named size scale in LaTeX the way `pq-size` provides one (3xs through 3xl) — the `size` key just takes a raw font-switching command, so the scale below is spelled out using the same LaTeX commands `pullquote.lua` would emit for each named step, plus `\fontsize{...}\selectfont` for an arbitrary point size.

```
\begin{pullquote}[size=\Large\itshape\rmfamily]
...
\end{pullquote}
```

***m:** Medium (base document size).*

***l:** Large (the .sty's default size).*

***xl:** Extra Large.*

***2xl:** Extra Extra Large.*

***3xl:** Extra Extra Extra Large.*

***24pt:** Custom arbitrary point size.*

Font Weights, Shapes, and Families

```
\begin{pullquote}[size=\large\bfseries\itshape\rmfamily]
This paragraph is in bold weight.
\end{pullquote}
```

This paragraph is in bold weight.

Pullquotes render in italics by default; `\upshape` overrides that back to upright.

This paragraph is explicitly rendered upright (non-italicized).

`\rmfamily/\sffamily/\ttfamily` match the same serif/sans/mono families `pq-family` resolves to across every format:

This paragraph is in serif.

This paragraph is in sans-serif.

This paragraph is in monospace.

Any other font name is a literal, applied directly via `\fontspec` (XeLaTeX/LuaLaTeX only) instead of going through `\rmfamily/\sffamily/\ttfamily`:

This pullquote uses a specific display font, independent of the document's main font.

Colors and Borders

Named SVG colors (loaded via `xcolor`'s `svgnames` option) work directly as `color/`
`barcolor` values; `barwidth` adjusts the left border's thickness. A `rem` value from the Pandoc specimen becomes the same number of `em` here, since both LaTeX and Typst resolve `em` natively against the current font size.

```
\begin{pullquote}[color=CadetBlue, barcolor=Thistle, barwidth=0.5em]
...
\end{pullquote}
```

*This quote uses the SVG named color **CadetBlue** for text and the pastel **Thistle** for a thick 0.5em border.*

`paddingleft` controls the gap between the bar and the text, independent of the bar's own thickness:



*This quote widens the gap between the bar and the text using **paddingleft=1.5em**, independent of the 0.5em bar thickness.*

The remaining three sides — paddingright, paddingtop, and paddingbottom — can each be tuned independently:



This quote sets an even 1em of padding on every side, giving the text room to breathe on all edges rather than just next to the bar.

6-digit and shorthand 3-digit hex codes both work, via `\definecolor{...}{HTML}{...}` plus a color/barcolor key naming the defined color (see the preamble above):



*This quote uses raw Hex codes: **#827397** for text and the shorthand **#FAA** (Soft Coral) for the bar.*

xcolor's percentage-mixing syntax (`Color!pct!Color`) works directly in color/barcolor — the same syntax `pullquote.lua` passes through unchanged for LaTeX output:



*This quote uses a three-part blend for the text (**Indigo mixed at 90% with Black**) and a standard two-part blend with white for the bar.*

Block-Level Positioning and Width

width and boxalign position the pullquote block within the page; boxalign takes tcolorbox's own keywords (flush left, center, flush right) rather than pq-box-align's left/center/right.



This quote takes up 45% of the page width and is aligned flush to the right margin.

Inner Text Alignment

`align` controls text alignment *within* the box — the same `\raggedright`/`\centering`/`\raggedleft` commands `pq-text-align` resolves to for LaTeX — independent of `boxalign`, which positions the box itself:

This quote takes up 70% of the page and is aligned to the left margin, but the text inside the box is centered.

Interline Spacing (Line-Height)

`skip` sets `\baselineskip` directly, rather than acting as a multiplier the way `pq-skip` does — so the `pq-skip="2.0"` equivalent below is spelled out as `2em`, matching what `pullquote.lua` itself emits for that same value:

This quote uses a 2em baselineskip, doubling the interline spacing to let the text breathe.

Tightening works the same way, with one caveat that is LaTeX's rather than this package's: TeX will not set a `\baselineskip` below the natural line height, so it falls back to `\lineskip` and quietly clamps values much under `1.2em`. The HTML and Typst pathways honour them instead.

This quote is deliberately tight, to show how far the lines can be pulled together before an engine stops following.

An explicit length behaves the same as it does in the filter: an `em` value scales with the `pullquote`'s own font size, so it stays proportional as size changes.

This quote sets its interline spacing as an explicit 1.6em length rather than a bare multiplier.

Global Configuration

There's no document metadata for a LaTeX `\pullquote` to fall back to, but `\pqsetdefaults` is the same idea: redefine it once, and every un-keyed `\pullquote` after that point picks up the new project-wide defaults automatically.

```

\renewcommand{\pqsetdefaults}{%
  \def\pqcolor{DarkSlateGray}%
  \def\pqbarcolor{CadetBlue}%
  \def\pqwidth{0.8\linewidth}%
  \def\pqboxalign{center}%
  \def\pqsize{\large\itshape\rmfamily}%
  \def\pqskip{\baselineskip}%
  \def\pqalign{\raggedright}%
  \def\pqbarwidth{4pt}%
  \def\pqpaddingleft{12pt}%
  \def\pqpaddingright{0pt}%
  \def\pqpaddingtop{4pt}%
  \def\pqpaddingbottom{4pt}%
}

```

This quote has no inline keys at all. It inherits its styling entirely from the redefined `\pqsetdefaults` above (centered, 80% width, DarkSlateGray text, CadetBlue bar).

Combining Multiple Attributes

Every key composes independently, the same as every `pq-*` attribute does across the other three formats:

The Ultimate Stress Test